Sri Lanka Institute of Information Technology

Assignment Report

Employability Skills Development module (IT2100)

2025

Personal Development Plan (PDP)

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Degree: BSc (Hons) in Information Technology

Year: 2

Semester: 2

1.Self-Assessment

To construct a successful personal development plan, I start by conducting a comprehensive self-evaluation of my academic, personal, and professional qualities using the strategy of SWOT analysis. a thorough skills evaluation to determine my present role, qualifications, and areas in need of development. I was able to objectively evaluate my strengths and weaknesses, as well as the opportunities and threats that could impede my progress, thanks to this method.

Strengths

As seen by my consistently good success in practical coding modules and algorithm-based coursework, I possess strong technical proficiency in both Python and Java. I have mastered the art of effectively debugging complex code and am very good at addressing mathematical problems logically. I am also very self-motivated to pick up new technologies on my own and use official documentation and online resources like Stack Overflow to broaden my knowledge and abilities.

Weaknesses

One of my shortcomings, which occasionally reduces my effectiveness in presentations, is my insecurity while speaking in front of big crowds. Additionally, I have a tendency to put off doing long-term projects, which can hinder my productivity. Furthermore, I need to hone my skills in more complex areas like backend development and cloud computing because I have little professional work experience in the IT sector.

Opportunities

I may improve my technical and soft skills by taking use of beneficial possibilities like workshops, professional certifications, and online learning platforms. Another approach to obtain industry experience is through internship programs and university career fairs. Peer, mentor, and instructor advice can also help me grow both personally and professionally.

Threats

One of the biggest challenges I confront is the fierce rivalry in the IT employment market, where many applicants possess both industry experience and academic credentials. Because of the speed at which technology is developing, staying current demands constant study. Additionally, there is a chance of stress and burnout while juggling personal obligations and academic demands.

Personality traits

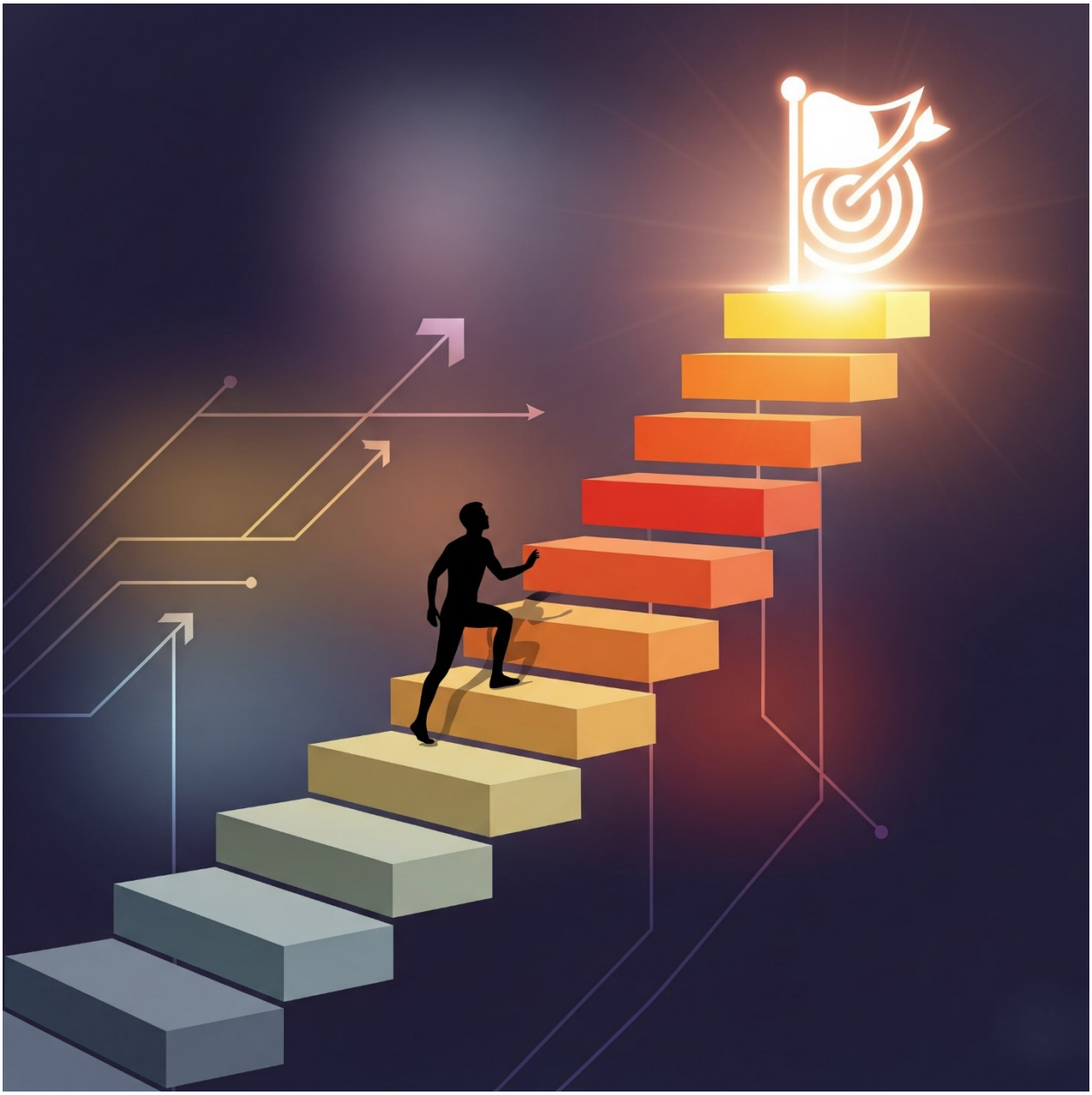
INFJ, according to the MBTI framework, is a good fit for my organized and sympathetic personality. My career goals in marketing management are motivated by my values of honesty and teamwork. I prefer structured settings to fully assimilate knowledge because I am a visual and reflective learner.

Skills Audit

Although I can communicate well in writing, I still need to work on my spoken presentations. Although teamwork is a strength, leadership abilities need to be improved. Technical abilities (such as graphic design software) are basic and require improvement for work preparedness, while time management is modest.

This self-evaluation identifies important areas for improvement, especially in time management, technical abilities, and public speaking, which will guide my goal-setting.

2.Goal Setting



Based on my self-assessment, I have established several SMART goals to support my personal and professional growth.

My short-term objective is to contribute to a collaborative software project over the course of the next six to nine months in order to improve my teamwork abilities. I intend to participate in a group project through the Tech Society or as a module assignment in order to accomplish this. Successful code contributions on Git using a shared repository and encouraging peer feedback will be indicators of my development. Since I want to attend the upcoming Tech Society meeting in order to find an appropriate project, this goal is both practical and attainable. It is extremely pertinent since it specifically addresses my need to enhance collaboration in coding settings and has a deadline of November 2025, the end of Year 2, Semester 2.

My medium-term goal is to get a 12-month industrial placement in the next year or two, either as a DevOps intern or as a Software Development Engineer during my third year. Applying to at least 20 placement schemes will help me do this and improve my chances of getting accepted. Securing and accepting at least one offer will be used to gauge progress, and the placement must be related to IT. This aim is time-bound to be accomplished by April 1st, 2025, with the placement starting in the summer of 2025, and it is very attainable with consistent preparation and applications. I will gain important industrial exposure, professional networking possibilities, and the ability to put my academic knowledge to use in practical situations thanks to this experience.

My long-term objective is to graduate and land a full-time position in a tech-focused organization as a DevOps Engineer or Back-End Software Engineer within three to five years. Signing a formal employment contract in one of these positions will serve as a gauge of my development. This objective is both doable and feasible given the experience from a placement year and the completion of a quality senior project. Unlike front-end design, it immediately relates to my interests in logical systems, infrastructure, and problem-solving. My goal is to accomplish this by Nov 2027, six months after I graduate.

Is your objective Specific? _____ SPECIFIC ☑
Can you Measure progress towards goal?_____ MEASURABLE ☑
Is the goal realistically Achievable?_____ ACHIEVABLE ☑
How Relevant is the goal to your organization?___ RELEVANT ☑
What is the Time for achieving this goal?_____ TIME BASED ☑

3. Action Planning

Attending the upcoming University Tech Society conference in November 2025 and forming a study group for my "Software Engineering" module are the first steps I intend to take to accomplish my first aim of enhancing teamwork and acquiring project experience. In my group assignment, I would suggest using Git for version control in December 2025 and offer to take charge of repository setup. In order to make sure that my contributions are understandable by team members, I will thereafter continue to follow sound version control practices by creating concise commit messages and include well-documented comments in my code. By doing these actions, I will be able to work with others more effectively and maintain my technical professionalism when working on team projects.

In order to achieve my second aim of landing a job, I will first schedule a CV clinic with the university's Careers Service by November 2025 in order to customize my resume for positions in technology. I'll also make a LinkedIn profile and interact with IT industry professors and graduates in order to broaden my professional network. From December 2025 to January 2026, I will look into organizations that offer positions and apply frequently, trying to submit at least five applications every week in January. In order to get ready for technical examinations, I'll practice at least two coding issues every week on sites like LeetCode and finish a practice interview with the Careers Service. My application quality and technical preparedness for landing a job will both be enhanced by these steps.

I will utilize the summer of 2024, assuming I land a placement, to concentrate on studying the company's unique technological stack and comprehending their professional workflows in order to achieve my third aim of graduating and gaining advanced abilities. I plan to choose a Final Year Project in my third year that focuses on back-end development, integrates cloud deployment with AWS or Azure, and uses Agile methodology to mimic real-world development processes. In addition, I plan to further my professional development by finishing an online course on DevOps ideas on Udemy and by getting practical experience with platforms like Jenkins or Docker. I'll be able to close the knowledge gap between academia and industry by taking these actions.

4. Monitoring & Evaluation Strategy

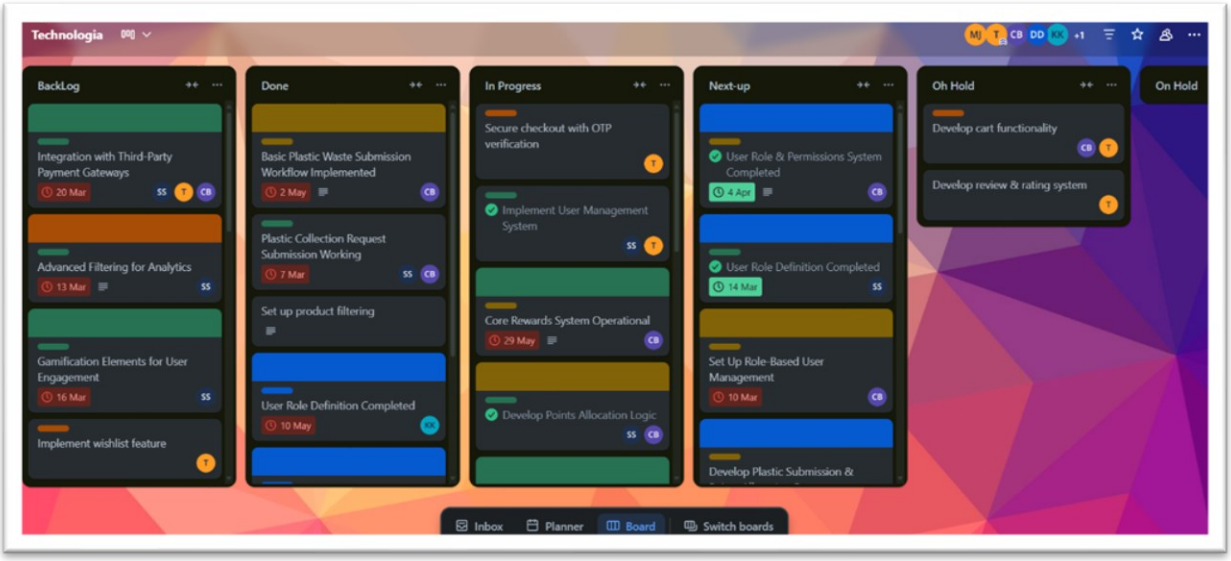
I will manage my action plan items on a Trello board, going from "To-Do" to "Doing" and then "Done," so that I can keep track of and assess my progress. This will provide me with a clear visual picture of my progress.

In addition, my GitHub page will serve as a living log of my technological progress and a professional portfolio, where I will consistently contribute through frequent commits.

I will perform a skills review every three months by repeating the audit from my self-assessment in order to quantify progress and pinpoint any areas that might not be progressing as planned.

I'll also create feedback loops by asking mentors and peers to review my code on GitHub and asking for helpful criticism following interviews so I can better understand where I can improve my methods and abilities.

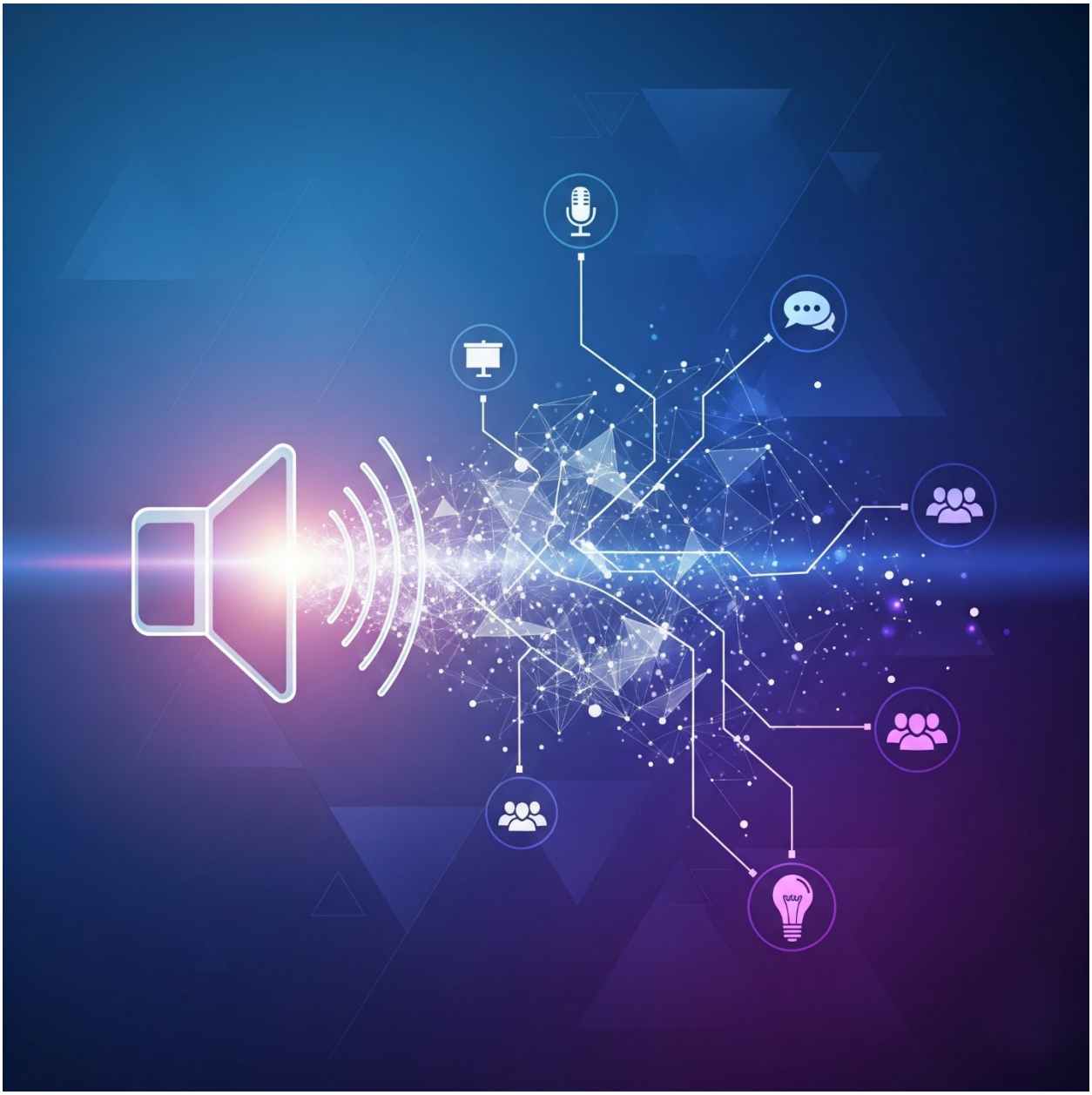
Trello board:



5. Personal Insight & Motivation

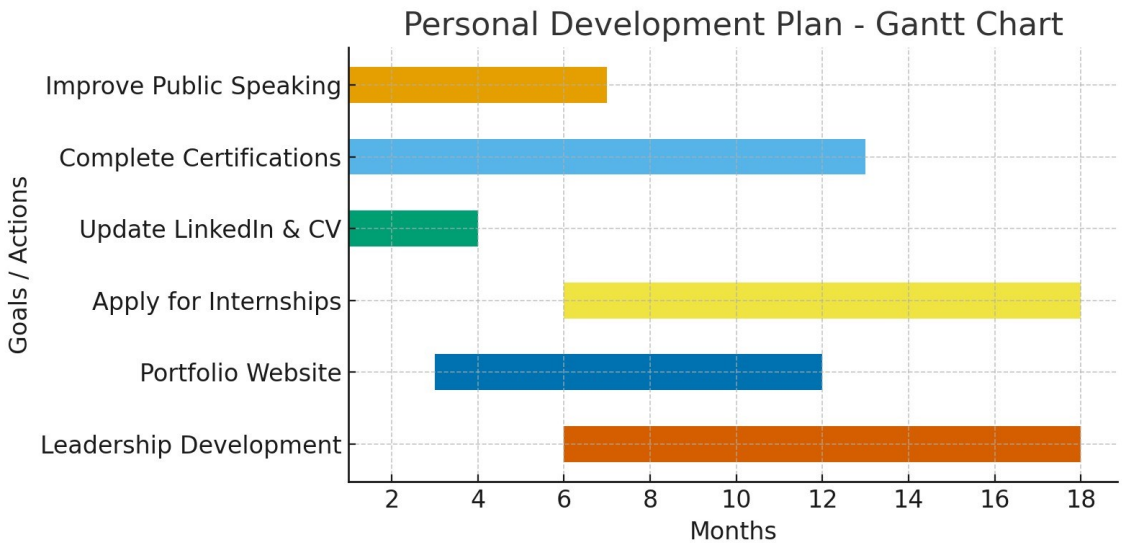
My ambition to create solutions that effectively and efficiently tackle real-world problems is what drives me to pursue a career in technology. I acknowledge that contemporary software engineering is a social endeavor, even if I take solace in the logical certainty of code. The goal of overcoming my hesitancy to work with others is to become a more influential and successful engineer, not only to land a job. The constant learning process required in this sector motivates me. It is tremendously inspiring to think about working on a codebase that supports thousands of people. This PDP serves as my road map for becoming a collaborative developer who can contribute to a professional team after working as a lone coder.

6. Presentation & Communication

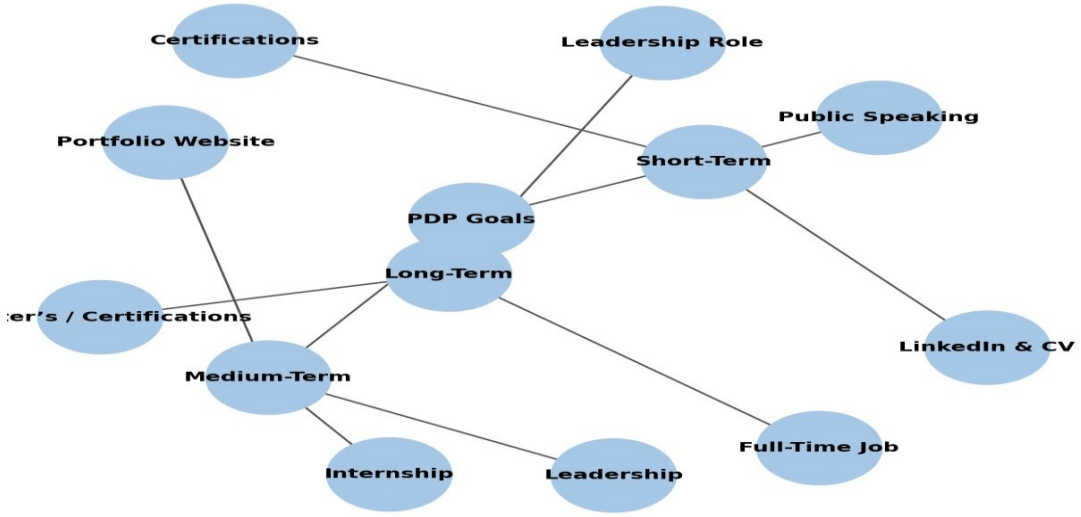


With logical, unambiguous section headers, this text has been organized to follow the criteria. Technical terms are utilized correctly, but they are clarified as needed. The work has been checked to make sure it is free of spelling and grammar mistakes, showcasing my attention to detail, and the language is clear and professional. Additionally, this PDP is organized with logical flow, quality layout, and distinct sections. I intend to use visual aids like a mind map that encapsulates my objectives and development strategy and a Gantt chart to illustrate the timeframe of my action plan in order to further enhance communication and clarity. The PDP will become easier to comprehend and more interesting with these enhancements.

Gantt Chart



Mind Map



7. Use of Tools & Evidence

GitHub Repository : I have begun populating my GitHub (github.com/Mathu-code) with university projects and small personal scripts

LinkedIn Profile: I have created a LinkedIn profile outlining my skills and projects. A screenshot is included below to demonstrate my initial step in building a professional online presence. My profile can also be accessed directly via this link: LinkedInProfile.

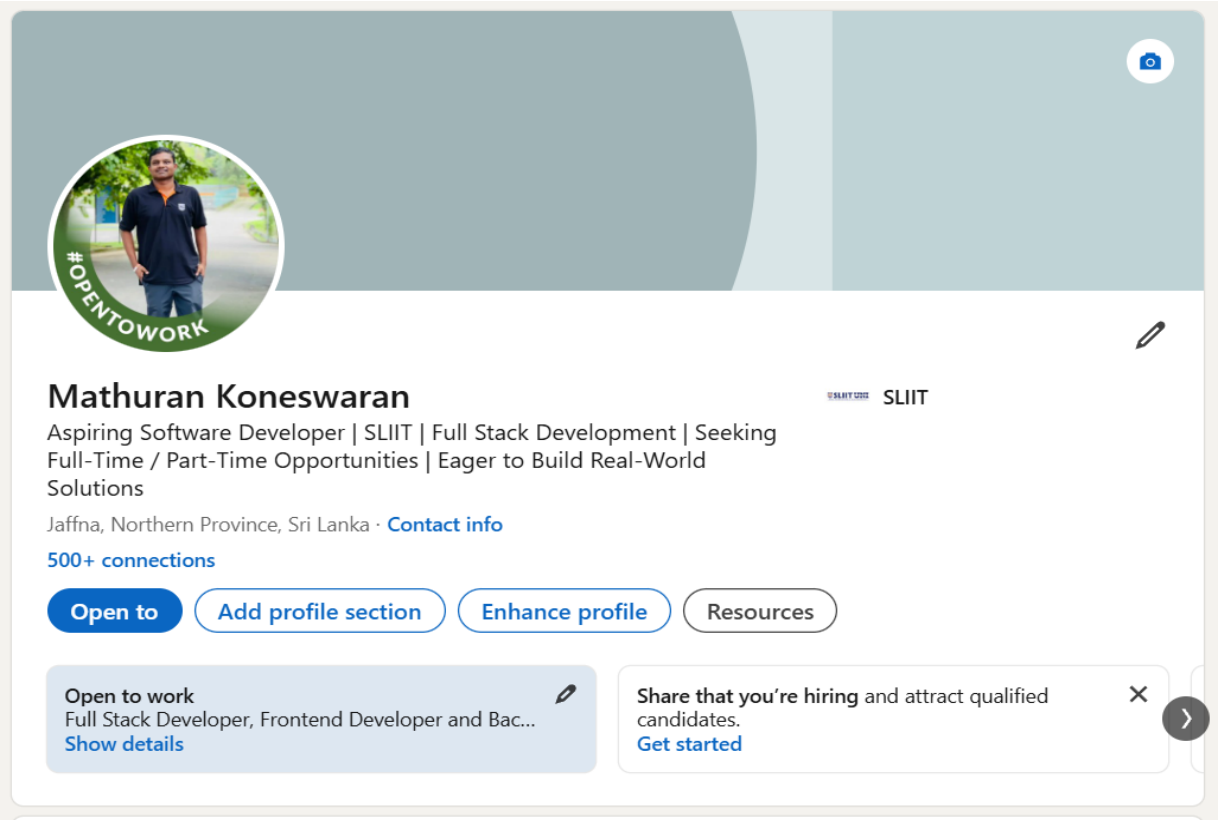
Past Feedback: Think back on the criticism you've had from peers, employers, or instructors. For example, you can cite your previous internship supervisor's praise of your excellent teamwork abilities as proof to back up your self-evaluation.

external resources:

https://www.highspeedtraining.co.uk/hub/personal-development-plan-template/

https://www.qualtrics.com/experience-management/employee/personal-development-plan/

LinkedIn Profile Screenshot:



CV
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Thank you